over the Shah Sahib headquarters and warned that any group operating in Mohmand must show allegiance to the TTP.[116] Local commander rivalry appears to have been one driver of the altercation. However, some sources have suggested Omar Khalid's response was fueled partly by suspicions that the Lashkar-linked Shah Sahib group was collaborating with the security services, hence the initial attack. Baitullah sought to smooth things out and his spokesman at the time, Qari Hussain Mehsud, stated that Shah group is our ally and his death is a big loss for all of us.[117] The situation was resolved soon after and the Shah Sahib group continued operating in Mohmand agency and working with the TTP.

Collaboration with the TTP and other actors was centered on the jihad in Afghanistan. Lashkar's leaders drew the line at fighting against Pakistan. However, because of the interconnectedness of groups fighting on both sides of the Durand Line, collaboration in Afghanistan sometimes elided into action against Pakistan. Increased integration with other actors launching attacks in Pakistan inevitably led some Lashkar members to become involved in anti-state violence. This included: facilitating the movement of suicide bombers and other terrorists from the NWFP and FATA to the Punjab; building or supplying explosive material for attacks and helping to move this material through the country; providing safe houses and false identity papers to would-be terrorists; and conducting target surveillance.[118] It is difficult to decipher when this cooperation took place at the organizational level and when individuals were freelancing. Moreover, because debates existed within the group about whether to cooperate on attacks against the state, organizational involvement could amount to factions deciding to collaborate with the leadership looking the other way. Most interlocutors believed that those Lashkar members who provided manpower (as opposed to facilitation) to the TTP or other actors for anti-state violence were freelancing. This did not mean that they had split from the group, though in addition to those who engaged in freelancing there were small fissiparous units believed to be active in the Tribal Areas by this point too.[119] Finally, operating in the Tribal Areas meant that even those Lashkar members who were not part of the insurgency in Pakistan or engaged in freelance activities ran the risk of coming under fire from the army. Sometimes the concept of self-defense mutated, prompting militants previously opposed to anti-state violence to engage in it. For example, one Pakistan-based journalist recounted the case